

SCHEME PERFORMANCE, CONVERGENCE, TARGETING AND DATA

THE FIVE-STAGE PERFORMANCE CYCLE → SOCIAL-ASSISTANCE UMBRELLA → DATABASE AGAINST CENSUS → TARGETING-ERROR MATRIX → DELIVERY MACHINERY → ONE HOUSEHOLD, SIX MINISTRIES

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g1 • explicit approval of this exact generation is required • all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00 THE FIVE-STAGE PERFORMANCE CYCLE

THE FIVE-STAGE PERFORMANCE CYCLE STAGE 1 TARGETING WHO IS ELIGIBLE DEPRIVATION DATABASE, IDENTITY, STATE AND GROUP LISTS STAGE 2 DELIVERY TRANSFER RAILS, FUND-FLOW SYSTEMS AND FRONTLINE CADRES STAGE 3 CONVERGENCE SEVERAL MINISTRIES MEETING AT ONE HOUSEHOLD

STAGE 1 TARGETING → who is eligible: deprivation database, identity, State and group lists STAGE 2 DELIVERY: transfer rails, fund-flow systems and frontline cadres STAGE 3 CONVERGENCE: several ministries meeting at one household STAGE 4 OUTCOME: surveys and composite indices measuring what actually changed STAGE 5 CORRECTION: evaluation and grievance feeding evidence back into redesign

SOCIAL STRUCTURE / CONCEPT

- STAGE 1 TARGETING → who is eligible: deprivation database, identity, State and group lists
- STAGE 2 DELIVERY: transfer rails, fund-flow systems and frontline cadres

MECHANISM OF CHANGE

- STAGE 3 CONVERGENCE: several ministries meeting at one household
- STAGE 4 OUTCOME: surveys and composite indices measuring what actually changed

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- STAGE 5 CORRECTION: evaluation and grievance feeding evidence back into redesign
- STAGE 1 TARGETING → who is eligible: deprivation database, identity, State and group lists

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: STAGE 5 CORRECTION: evaluation and grievance feeding evidence back into redesign.

01

STAGE 01 SOCIAL-ASSISTANCE UMBRELLA

SOCIAL-ASSISTANCE UMBRELLA OLD AGE INDIRA GANDHI NATIONAL OLD AGE PENSION SCHEME INDIRA GANDHI NATIONAL WIDOW PENSION SCHEME INDIRA GANDHI NATIONAL DISABILITY PENSION SCHEME NATIONAL FAMILY BENEFIT SCHEME, A LUMP SUM ON A

ANNA PURNA, FOR ELDERLY PERSONS NOT COVERED BY A PENSION

OLD AGE → Indira Gandhi National Old Age Pension Scheme

WIDOW → Indira Gandhi National Widow Pension Scheme

DISABILITY → Indira Gandhi National Disability Pension Scheme

BEREAVEMENT → National Family Benefit Scheme, a lump sum on a breadwinner's death

SOCIAL STRUCTURE / CONCEPT

- OLD AGE → Indira Gandhi National Old Age Pension Scheme
- WIDOW → Indira Gandhi National Widow Pension Scheme

MECHANISM OF CHANGE

- DISABILITY → Indira Gandhi National Disability Pension Scheme
- BEREAVEMENT → National Family Benefit Scheme, a lump sum on a breadwinner's death

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- FOOD → Annapurna, for elderly persons not covered by a pension; States may top up
- OLD AGE → Indira Gandhi National Old Age Pension Scheme

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: FOOD → Annapurna, for elderly persons not covered by a pension; States may top up.

02

STAGE 02 DATABASE AGAINST CENSUS

DATABASE AGAINST CENSUS TARGETING DATABASE 2011 DEPRIVATION AND OCCUPATION CRITERIA HOUSING, LAND, ASSETS CORE ELIGIBILITY ROUTE OF THE HEALTH-ASSURANCE SCHEME NOT USED FOR THE SEPARATE AGE-BASED ROUTE COVERING ALL PERSONS AGED SEVENTY DECENNIAL CENSUS

SOCIAL UNIT / DEFINITION

TARGETING DATABASE 2011 → deprivation and occupation criteria: housing, land, assets

USE → core eligibility route of the health-assurance scheme

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

NOT USED FOR → the separate age-based route covering all persons aged seventy and above

DECENNIAL CENSUS → universal population enumeration with a different purpose and method

EXAM TRAP / LIMIT

CASTE DATA → collected in 2011; not released or validated for general policy use

TARGETING DATABASE 2011 → deprivation and occupation criteria: housing, land, assets

SOCIAL UNIT / DEFINITION

- TARGETING DATABASE 2011 → deprivation and occupation criteria: housing, land, assets
- USE → core eligibility route of the health-assurance scheme

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- NOT USED FOR → the separate age-based route covering all persons aged seventy and above
- DECENNIAL CENSUS → universal population enumeration with a different purpose and method

EXAM TRAP / LIMIT

- CASTE DATA → collected in 2011; not released or validated for general policy use
- TARGETING DATABASE 2011 → deprivation and occupation criteria: housing, land, assets

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CASTE DATA → collected in 2011; not released or validated for general policy use.

03

STAGE 03 TARGETING-ERROR MATRIX

TARGETING-ERROR MATRIX INCLUSION ERROR AN INELIGIBLE PERSON IS INCLUDED; RESOURCES LEAK TO THE EXCLUSION ERROR AN ELIGIBLE PERSON IS LEFT OUT; THE NEEDY MISS TIGHTER VERIFICATION LOWERS INCLUSION ERROR AND RAISES EXCLUSION ERROR

LOWERS EXCLUSION ERROR AND RAISES INCLUSION ERROR

SOCIAL UNIT / DEFINITION

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

EXAM TRAP / LIMIT

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CASTE DATA — collected in 2011; not released or validated for general policy use.

03

STAGE 03 TARGETING-ERROR MATRIX

TARGETING-ERROR MATRIX

INCLUSION ERROR

AN INELIGIBLE PERSON IS INCLUDED; RESOURCES LEAK TO THE

EXCLUSION ERROR

AN ELIGIBLE PERSON IS LEFT OUT; THE NEEDY MISS

TIGHTER VERIFICATION

LOWERS INCLUSION ERROR AND RAISES EXCLUSION ERROR

LOWERS EXCLUSION ERROR AND RAISES INCLUSION ERROR

SOCIAL UNIT / DEFINITION	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EXAM TRAP / LIMIT
INCLUSION ERROR → an ineligible person is included; resources leak to the non-poor	TIGHTER VERIFICATION → lowers inclusion error and raises exclusion error	RULE → a design chooses which error to bear; it does not remove both
EXCLUSION ERROR → an eligible person is left out; the needy miss the benefit	SELF-DECLARATION → lowers exclusion error and raises inclusion error	INCLUSION ERROR → an ineligible person is included; resources leak to the non-poor
SOCIAL UNIT / DEFINITION • INCLUSION ERROR → an ineligible person is included; resources leak to the non-poor • EXCLUSION ERROR → an eligible person is left out; the needy miss the benefit	DECISIVE DISTINCTION • TIGHTER VERIFICATION → lowers inclusion error and raises exclusion error • SELF-DECLARATION → lowers exclusion error and raises inclusion error	EXAM TRAP / LIMIT • RULE → a design chooses which error to bear; it does not remove both • INCLUSION ERROR → an ineligible person is included; resources leak to the non-poor

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → a design chooses which error to bear; it does not remove both.

04

STAGE 04 DELIVERY MACHINERY

DELIVERY MACHINERY

TRANSFER RAIL

DIRECT BENEFIT TRANSFER ON THE IDENTITY, ACCOUNT AND MOBILE

FUND FLOW

THE PUBLIC FINANCIAL MANAGEMENT SYSTEM AND SINGLE NODAL AGENCY

LAST MILE

AUXILIARY NURSE MIDWIFE, HEALTH ACTIVIST, ANGANWADI WORKER, PANCHAYAT SECRETARY

URBAN LOCAL BODIES AND PANCHAYATI RAJ INSTITUTIONS IMPLEMENT

TRANSFER RAIL → direct benefit transfer on the identity, account and mobile trinity

FUND FLOW → the public financial management system and single nodal agency arrangement

LAST MILE → auxiliary nurse midwife, health activist, anganwadi worker, panchayat secretary

TIER → urban local bodies and panchayati raj institutions implement

LIMIT → faster transfers do not give a frontline worker a household-wide view

SOCIAL STRUCTURE / CONCEPT

- TRANSFER RAIL → direct benefit transfer on the identity, account and mobile trinity
- FUND FLOW → the public financial management system and single nodal agency arrangement

MECHANISM OF CHANGE

- LAST MILE → auxiliary nurse midwife, health activist, anganwadi worker, panchayat secretary
- TIER → urban local bodies and panchayati raj institutions implement

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- LIMIT → faster transfers do not give a frontline worker a household-wide view
- TRANSFER RAIL → direct benefit transfer on the identity, account and mobile trinity

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT → faster transfers do not give a frontline worker a household-wide view.

05

STAGE 05 ONE HOUSEHOLD, SIX MINISTRIES

ONE HOUSEHOLD, SIX MINISTRIES

FOREST RIGHTS

TRIBAL AFFAIRS MINISTRY WITH THE STATE FOREST DEPARTMENT

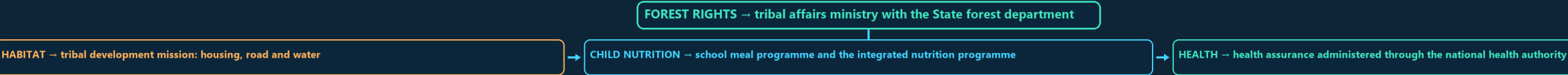
TRIBAL DEVELOPMENT MISSION

HOUSING, ROAD AND WATER

CHILD NUTRITION

SCHOOL MEAL PROGRAMME AND THE INTEGRATED NUTRITION PROGRAMME

HEALTH ASSURANCE ADMINISTERED THROUGH THE NATIONAL HEALTH AUTHORITY



SOCIAL STRUCTURE / CONCEPT

- FOREST RIGHTS → tribal affairs ministry with the State forest department
- HABITAT → tribal development mission: housing, road and water

MECHANISM OF CHANGE

- CHILD NUTRITION → school meal programme and the integrated nutrition programme
- HEALTH → health assurance administered through the national health authority

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- OLD AGE → social-assistance pension from the rural development ministry
- FOREST RIGHTS → tribal affairs ministry with the State forest department

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: OLD AGE → social-assistance pension from the rural development ministry.

06

STAGE 06 CONVERGENCE FAILURE CHAIN

CONVERGENCE FAILURE CHAIN

STEP 1

EACH MINISTRY KEEPS ITS OWN ELIGIBILITY DATABASE; NO INTEROPERABLE

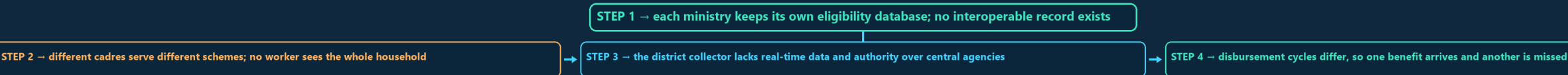
STEP 2

DIFFERENT CADRES SERVE DIFFERENT SCHEMES; NO WORKER SEES THE

STEP 3

THE DISTRICT COLLECTOR LACKS REAL-TIME DATA AND AUTHORITY OVER

STEP 4



SOCIAL STRUCTURE / CONCEPT

MECHANISM OF CHANGE

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

06

STAGE 06 CONVERGENCE FAILURE CHAIN

CONVERGENCE FAILURE CHAIN STEP 1 EACH MINISTRY KEEPS ITS OWN ELIGIBILITY DATABASE; NO INTEROPERABLE STEP 2 DIFFERENT CADRES SERVE DIFFERENT SCHEMES; NO WORKER SEES THE STEP 3 THE DISTRICT COLLECTOR LACKS REAL-TIME DATA AND AUTHORITY OVER STEP 4

STEP 1 → each ministry keeps its own eligibility database; no interoperable record exists

STEP 2 → different cadres serve different schemes; no worker sees the whole household

STEP 3 → the district collector lacks real-time data and authority over central agencies

STEP 4 → disbursement cycles differ, so one benefit arrives and another is missed

SOCIAL STRUCTURE / CONCEPT

- STEP 1 → each ministry keeps its own eligibility database; no interoperable record exists
- STEP 2 → different cadres serve different schemes; no worker sees the whole household

MECHANISM OF CHANGE

- STEP 3 → the district collector lacks real-time data and authority over central agencies
- STEP 4 → disbursement cycles differ, so one benefit arrives and another is missed

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- RESULT → convergence is architectural, so exhortation cannot produce it
- STEP 1 → each ministry keeps its own eligibility database; no interoperable record exists

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RESULT → convergence is architectural, so exhortation cannot produce it.

07

STAGE 07 DATA TYPE AND RESULT LEVEL

DATA TYPE AND RESULT LEVEL HIGH FREQUENCY, PROGRAMME-SPECIFIC, EXCLUDES THE NON-ENROLLED COMPARABLE INDICATORS, SAMPLED, CARRIES A REPORTING LAG UNIVERSAL COVERAGE, INFREQUENT AND SLOW OUTPUT VERSUS OUTCOME MEALS SERVED AGAINST NUTRITIONAL STATUS

LONG-TERM CAPABILITY SUCH AS COGNITIVE DEVELOPMENT, ESTIMATED BY EVALUATION

SOCIAL UNIT / DEFINITION

ADMINISTRATIVE → high frequency, programme-specific, excludes the non-enrolled
SURVEY → comparable indicators, sampled, carries a reporting lag

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

CENSUS → universal coverage, infrequent and slow
OUTPUT VERSUS OUTCOME → meals served against nutritional status

EXAM TRAP / LIMIT

IMPACT → long-term capability such as cognitive development, estimated by evaluation
ADMINISTRATIVE → high frequency, programme-specific, excludes the non-enrolled

SOCIAL UNIT / DEFINITION

- ADMINISTRATIVE → high frequency, programme-specific, excludes the non-enrolled
- SURVEY → comparable indicators, sampled, carries a reporting lag

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- CENSUS → universal coverage, infrequent and slow
- OUTPUT VERSUS OUTCOME → meals served against nutritional status

EXAM TRAP / LIMIT

- IMPACT → long-term capability such as cognitive development, estimated by evaluation
- ADMINISTRATIVE → high frequency, programme-specific, excludes the non-enrolled

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: IMPACT → long-term capability such as cognitive development, estimated by evaluation.

08

STAGE 08 OUTCOME INSTRUMENTS CARD

OUTCOME INSTRUMENTS CARD HEALTH AND NUTRITION THE NATIONAL FAMILY HEALTH SURVEY OF THE HEALTH MINISTRY THE PERIODIC LABOUR FORCE SURVEY OF THE STATISTICS MINISTRY DISCRIMINATION AND CRIME NATIONAL CRIME RECORDS BUREAU DATA

THE SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT GOAL INDIA INDEX AND THE POVERTY ROUND RULE

SOCIAL UNIT / DEFINITION

HEALTH AND NUTRITION → the National Family Health Survey of the health ministry
EMPLOYMENT → the Periodic Labour Force Survey of the statistics ministry

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

DISCRIMINATION AND CRIME → National Crime Records Bureau data
COMPOSITE → the Sustainable Development Goal India Index and the poverty index

EXAM TRAP / LIMIT

ROUND RULE → sixth round 2023-24, released 29 May 2026; stunting 29.3% against 35.5%
HEALTH AND NUTRITION → the National Family Health Survey of the health ministry

SOCIAL UNIT / DEFINITION

- HEALTH AND NUTRITION → the National Family Health Survey of the health ministry
- EMPLOYMENT → the Periodic Labour Force Survey of the statistics ministry

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- DISCRIMINATION AND CRIME → National Crime Records Bureau data
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EXAM TRAP / LIMIT

- ROUND RULE → sixth round 2023-24, released 29 May 2026; stunting 29.3% against 35.5%
- HEALTH AND NUTRITION → the National Family Health Survey of the health ministry

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ROUND RULE → sixth round 2023-24, released 29 May 2026; stunting 29.3% against 35.5%.

09

STAGE 09 TARGETING-ERROR CHAIN

TARGETING-ERROR CHAIN A 2011 LIST MISSES MOVEMENT, INCOME CHANGE AND NEWLY IDENTITY NUMBER, RATION CARD OR CERTIFICATE PROXIES FOR IDENTITY VERIFICATION CHOICE SELF-DECLARATION LEAKS; CERTIFICATION EXCLUDES THE UNDOCUMENTED PROXY LIMITS

HOUSING, LAND AND ASSETS IMPERFECTLY TRACK INCOME OR CONSUMPTION ASSISTED AND NON-DIGITAL ALTERNATIVES WITH A CORRECTION ROUTE

VINTAGE → a 2011 list misses movement, income change and newly arising deprivation

DOCUMENTS: identity number, ration card or certificate proxies for identity, not need

VERIFICATION CHOICE: self-declaration leaks; certification excludes the undocumented

PROXY LIMITS: housing, land and assets imperfectly track income or consumption poverty

SAFEGUARD → assisted and non-digital alternatives with a correction route

SOCIAL STRUCTURE / CONCEPT

- VINTAGE → a 2011 list misses movement, income change and newly arising deprivation
- DOCUMENTS: identity number, ration card or certificate proxies for identity, not need

MECHANISM OF CHANGE

- VERIFICATION CHOICE: self-declaration leaks; certification excludes the undocumented
- PROXY LIMITS: housing, land and assets imperfectly track income or consumption poverty

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- SAFEGUARD → assisted and non-digital alternatives with a correction route
- VINTAGE → a 2011 list misses movement, income change and newly arising deprivation

09

STAGE 09 TARGETING-ERROR CHAIN

TARGETING-ERROR CHAIN A 2011 LIST MISSES MOVEMENT, INCOME CHANGE AND NEWLY HOUSING, LAND AND ASSETS IMPERFECTLY TRACK INCOME OR CONSUMPTION IDENTITY NUMBER, RATION CARD OR CERTIFICATE PROXIES FOR IDENTITY VERIFICATION CHOICE SELF-DECLARATION LEAKS; CERTIFICATION EXCLUDES THE UNDOCUMENTED PROXY LIMITS

HOUSING, LAND AND ASSETS IMPERFECTLY TRACK INCOME OR CONSUMPTION ASSISTED AND NON-DIGITAL ALTERNATIVES WITH A CORRECTION ROUTE



SOCIAL STRUCTURE / CONCEPT

- VINTAGE → a 2011 list misses movement, income change and newly arising deprivation
- DOCUMENTS: identity number, ration card or certificate proxies for identity, not need

MECHANISM OF CHANGE

- VERIFICATION CHOICE: self-declaration leaks; certification excludes the undocumented
- PROXY LIMITS: housing, land and assets imperfectly track income or consumption poverty

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- SAFEGUARD → assisted and non-digital alternatives with a correction route
- VINTAGE → a 2011 list misses movement, income change and newly arising deprivation

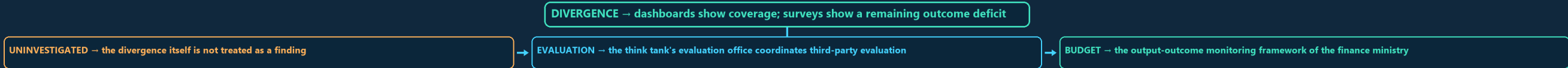
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SAFEGUARD → assisted and non-digital alternatives with a correction route.

10

STAGE 10 CORRECTION FAILURE AND ITS INSTRUMENTS

CORRECTION FAILURE AND ITS INSTRUMENTS DASHBOARDS SHOW COVERAGE; SURVEYS SHOW A REMAINING OUTCOME DEFICIT THE DIVERGENCE ITSELF IS NOT TREATED AS A FINDING THE THINK TANK'S EVALUATION OFFICE COORDINATES THIRD-PARTY EVALUATION

THE OUTPUT-OUTCOME MONITORING FRAMEWORK OF THE FINANCE MINISTRY FINDINGS STAY IN REPORTS BECAUSE ALLOCATION DOES NOT DEPEND



SOCIAL STRUCTURE / CONCEPT

- DIVERGENCE → dashboards show coverage; surveys show a remaining outcome deficit
- UNINVESTIGATED → the divergence itself is not treated as a finding

MECHANISM OF CHANGE

- EVALUATION → the think tank's evaluation office coordinates third-party evaluation
- BUDGET → the output-outcome monitoring framework of the finance ministry

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- BREAK → findings stay in reports because allocation does not depend on them
- DIVERGENCE → dashboards show coverage; surveys show a remaining outcome deficit

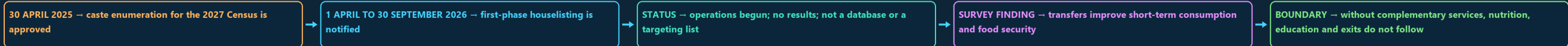
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: BREAK → findings stay in reports because allocation does not depend on them.

11

STAGE 11 PENDING DATA AND BOUNDED FINDINGS

PENDING DATA AND BOUNDED FINDINGS 30 APRIL 2025 CASTE ENUMERATION FOR THE 2027 CENSUS IS APPROVED 1 APRIL TO 30 SEPTEMBER 2026 FIRST-PHASE HOUSELISTING IS NOTIFIED OPERATIONS BEGUN; NO RESULTS; NOT A DATABASE OR A SURVEY FINDING

TRANSFERS IMPROVE SHORT-TERM CONSUMPTION AND FOOD SECURITY



OFFICIAL EVIDENCE / DATE

- 30 APRIL 2025 → caste enumeration for the 2027 Census is approved
- 1 APRIL TO 30 SEPTEMBER 2026 → first-phase houselisting is notified

WHAT IT PROVES

- STATUS → operations begun; no results; not a database or a targeting list
- SURVEY FINDING → transfers improve short-term consumption and food security

CLAIM LIMIT

- BOUNDARY → without complementary services, nutrition, education and exits do not follow
- 30 APRIL 2025 → caste enumeration for the 2027 Census is approved

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: BOUNDARY → without complementary services, nutrition, education and exits do not follow.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT INCLUSION (TYPE I) - DIFFERENT ELIGIBILITY DBS - COVERAGE EXCLUSION (TYPE II) - DIFFERENT MINISTRIES - ADMINISTRATIVE DATA IDENTIFICATION GAP - DIFFERENT FRONTLINE CADRES ≠ SURVEY DATA SECC CASTE DATA UNRELEASED

CENSUS 2027 CASTE ENUMERATION APPROVED; OPERATIONS BEGUN, NO RESULTS NO UNIVERSALLY INTEROPERABLE, CONTINUOUSLY UPDATED REGISTRY NSAP (MORD)

OPTIONAL RIGHTS AND CAPABILITY DEPTH

- Inclusion (Type I) - Different eligibility DBs - Coverage ≠ outcome
- Exclusion (Type II) - Different ministries - Administrative data
- Identification gap - Different frontline cadres ≠ survey data
- SECC caste data unreleased

INDICATOR, ROUND AND STATUS LIMIT

- Census 2027 caste enumeration approved; operations begun, no results (Topic 09)
- No universally interoperable, continuously updated registry
- NSAP (MoRD): Social-assistance umbrella; central contribution is fixed and
- SECC 2011 (MoRD): Static targeting database; no update since 2011; caste data

COMPARATIVE WELFARE-DESIGN NUANCE

- DMEQ (NITI Aayog): Evaluation and monitoring; OOMF mandates output-outcome
- CAUTION: Recommended reform: build a federated, purpose-limited interoperability layer with
- CAUTION: Recommended reform: mandate outcome-linked Budget allocations — incremental funding
- CAUTION: Recommended reform: assign District Collectors explicit convergence authority with

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.